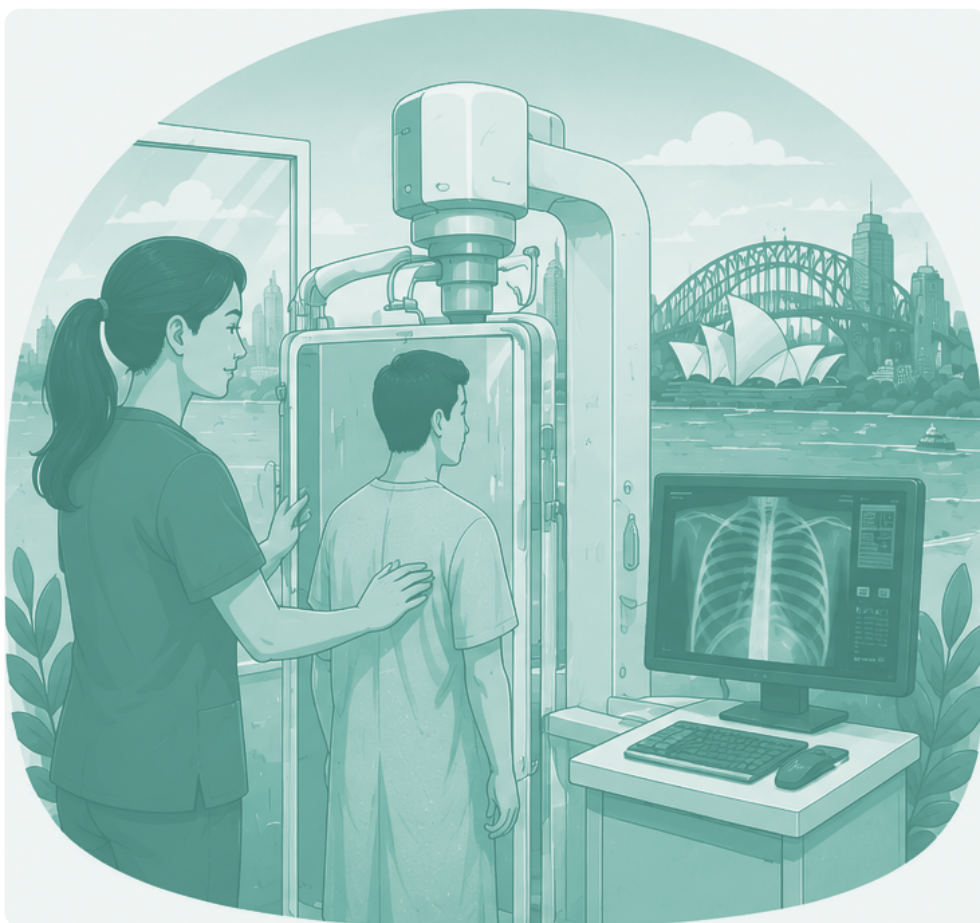


AUSTRALIA RESOURCE CENTRE

Sonographer Accreditation Guide

ASMIRT Recognition & ASAR Accreditation

Your complete guide to working as a sonographer in Australia — ASMIRT recognition and ASAR accreditation.



Welcome to your registration guide

Thinking about moving to Australia as a sonographer? This guide walks you through the pathway — and it's a little different from the other medical-imaging professions, so it's worth understanding clearly from the start.

Here's the key thing: in Australia, **sonographer is not a protected title** under the National Law, so the pathway isn't registration with a national board in the way it is for radiographers. Instead, the route that matters to employers runs through two bodies — an **ASMIRT** assessment of your qualifications, then **ASAR accreditation**. We explain both in Section 01.

Everything here comes from helping internationally qualified people make this move. We've kept it to what actually matters: getting your ultrasound qualification recognised, gaining ASAR accreditation, and being ready to evidence recent clinical practice.

How to use this guide

Read it through once to get the lie of the land, then keep it handy and come back to each section as you reach it. It's a handbook, not a leaflet.

An important note

This guide complements the official guidance from ASMIRT and ASAR — it doesn't replace it. Those bodies set the requirements and make the decisions, so where anything here differs from their published requirements, theirs takes precedence. We support and guide you through the process, and help you secure the role and sponsorship to get here — but the recognition and accreditation decisions rest with ASMIRT and ASAR.

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A quick word before you start

The thing to hold onto: sonographer is **not a protected title** in Australia, so your pathway runs through **ASMIRT recognition** and then **ASAR accreditation** — not national registration. Section 01 sets out how the two fit together.

How the sonographer pathway works

The sonographer pathway is different from the other medical-imaging professions, and understanding why up front saves a lot of confusion. Here it is in plain terms.

Sonographer is not a protected title

Unlike diagnostic radiographers or radiation therapists, **sonographer is not a protected title under the National Law** — so there's no national-board registration to "practise as a sonographer". That doesn't mean standards are relaxed: employers, and Medicare, rely on a professional accreditation instead.

The two-step route: ASMIRT then ASAR

For an overseas-qualified sonographer, the pathway runs through two bodies, in order:

- **1. ASMIRT** — the Australian Society of Medical Imaging and Radiation Therapy assesses your overseas ultrasound qualification and, if it meets the standard, issues a **Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound**.
- **2. ASAR** — with that certificate, you apply to the Australian Sonographer Accreditation Registry for **accreditation as a Medical Sonographer** (Category 1B). ASAR accreditation is what employers look for and what allows ultrasound to be billed under Medicare.

The key point

The ASMIRT Certificate of Recognition is the gateway: it's required **both** for ASAR accreditation **and** for skilled-migration purposes through the Department of Home Affairs. Get the ASMIRT assessment moving early — everything downstream depends on it.

ASMIRT & the Certificate of Recognition

Your first step is ASMIRT — the body that assesses overseas ultrasound qualifications and issues the Certificate of Recognition that everything else depends on.

ASMIRT (the Australian Society of Medical Imaging and Radiation Therapy) is authorised by the Department of Home Affairs to assess overseas qualifications for migration and professional recognition. For sonographers, it assesses your ultrasound qualification and clinical experience and, where the standard is met, issues a **Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound**.

What ASMIRT assesses

Your qualification is assessed for equivalence to the Australian standard **at the time you qualified**, together with the associated clinical work experience. Post-qualification education and further clinical experience may also be taken into account. The assessment is individual — there's no quick pre-review, so it's important to submit a complete, well-evidenced application.

The three possible outcomes

- **Unconditional Recognition** — your qualification and experience meet the standard; a Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound is issued (plus a letter for the immigration process).
- **Conditional** — you're asked to provide further documentation or undertake further clinical experience before recognition.
- **Not recognised** — the qualification doesn't meet the Australian standard at the time of qualification.

This certificate does two jobs

The Certificate of Recognition is required **both** for ASAR accreditation **and** by the Department of Home Affairs for skilled migration. One assessment, two uses — which is why it's the first thing to get moving.

ASAR accreditation (Category 1B)

With your ASMIRT Certificate of Recognition in hand, the next step is ASAR accreditation — the credential employers actually look for, and the one tied to Medicare.

What ASAR is

The Australian Sonographer Accreditation Registry (ASAR) maintains the register of **Accredited Medical Sonographers**. Because sonographer isn't a protected title, ASAR accreditation is the de-facto standard: to perform ultrasound on behalf of a medical practitioner under **Medicare**, you need to hold and maintain ASAR accreditation, and many employers require it as a condition of employment.

Applying under Category 1B

Overseas-qualified sonographers join the register via **Category 1B**. To be eligible you must:

- hold an **ASMIRT Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound**; and
- be an Australian or New Zealand citizen, a permanent resident, **or hold a valid Australian working visa**.

If you're accredited on the basis of a working visa, each year's renewal depends on presenting ASAR with proof of a valid work visa for that year.

Order matters

ASAR Category 1B requires the ASMIRT certificate first — so the sequence is always ASMIRT recognition, then ASAR accreditation. Application fees aren't refundable, so check every detail before submitting.

Recent practice & recency requirements

Both ASMIRT and ASAR care about recent, current clinical ultrasound practice — not just your original qualification. Being able to evidence it clearly is one of the biggest factors in a smooth application.

Why recency matters

Ultrasound is a hands-on, skill-based profession, so recent clinical practice is central to both the ASMIRT assessment and ASAR accreditation. ASMIRT weighs your associated clinical work experience alongside your qualification; ASAR applies its own recency expectations on entry.

The ASAR recency rule

If your ASMIRT Certificate of Recognition was obtained **more than three years ago**, ASAR generally expects evidence that you've been active for the equivalent of **one year part-time / six months full-time in clinical ultrasound in the last three years**. If you can't meet that, ASAR's **return-to-clinical- practice** policy applies instead.

Evidence to keep ready

Detailed employment references confirming your ultrasound roles, dates, modalities and caseload; a CV that maps clearly onto your scanning experience; and any logbook or caseload evidence you can provide. The clearer your recent-practice picture, the smoother both steps.

Ethicare Insight

The applicants who move fastest are the ones who can **evidence current scanning practice** without scrambling. If you're planning your move, keep your references, dates and modality breakdown organised from the start — it's the part you control, and it's the part that matters most.

Medicare, CPD & staying accredited

ASAR accreditation isn't a one-off — it's an ongoing status tied to Medicare billing and continuing professional development. Here's what keeping it involves.

Why accreditation is ongoing

To perform ultrasound on behalf of a medical practitioner under **Medicare**, you must hold and maintain ASAR accreditation and be included on the Register of Accredited Medical Sonographers. Many employers also require continuing accreditation as a condition of employment, so it's worth treating it as a status to maintain rather than a box ticked once.

Annual fee & CPD

To remain on the register you pay an **annual accreditation fee** and meet ASAR's **continuing professional development** requirement — at least **60 hours of CPD every three years**. (CPD for the profession is overseen at the national level; ASAR sets the accreditation-side requirements.)

Working-visa renewals

If you're accredited under Category 1B on the basis of a working visa, each year's renewal depends on giving ASAR proof of a valid work visa for that year — so keep your visa documentation current and to hand.

Plan CPD from day one

CPD is far easier to accrue steadily than to scramble for near a renewal deadline. Start logging activities as soon as you're accredited, and the three-yearly requirement looks after itself.

English language requirements

English-language evidence matters for sonographers in two places: the skilled-migration process, and many employers' own requirements. The exact requirement depends on your route.

Where English evidence is needed

For **skilled migration**, the Department of Home Affairs sets English requirements by visa subclass, and these are separate from the recognition and accreditation steps. **Employers** may also ask for evidence of English proficiency as part of recruitment. ASMIRT and ASAR will tell you what, if anything, they require as part of their own processes.

Confirm against the current requirement

We've deliberately not reproduced specific test scores here, because requirements differ by visa and are reviewed periodically. Confirm the exact English requirement for your visa subclass with the Department of Home Affairs (or a registered migration adviser), and check what your employer expects, before booking any test — we're happy to help you work out which applies.

Common mistake — testing too early

If you do need a test, time it so the result is still valid when your application reaches the Board. Sitting it too early risks the result expiring before you submit.

Your supporting documents

A clean, complete documentation pack is the single biggest factor within your control on timing. Here's what you'll generally be assembling.

Passport & proof of identity

Certified, with evidence of any name change.

Ultrasound qualification

Your qualifying award in medical ultrasound / sonography.

Academic transcript

Full record of subjects, results and the grading system.

Recent clinical ultrasound evidence

Logbook / caseload showing recent scanning practice and modalities.

ASMIRT Certificate of Recognition

Once issued — the gateway to ASAR Category 1B.

Professional references

Confirming your ultrasound roles, dates and responsibilities.

Employment history & CV

Roles, dates and responsibilities, up to date.

English & visa evidence

As required for your visa subclass / by your employer.

Present it like a professional portfolio

Certified copies (not copies of certified copies), clean high-resolution scans, consistent naming, pages complete and straight. A well-organised application is assessed faster than a disorganised one containing exactly the same facts.

Before you apply

Before diving into the detail, here's your immediate action list. Running through these five steps first is the simplest way to start on the front foot.

- ✓ **Check recognition**
Understand the ASMIRT recognition step — it's the gateway to everything else.
- ✓ **Understand your pathway**
ASMIRT recognition, then ASAR accreditation (Category 1B) — know the order.
- ✓ **Gather your documents**
Identity, degree, transcript, evidence of recent ultrasound practice, references, CV.
- ✓ **Decide your visa route**
Employer-sponsored (482) or skilled migration — this determines whether an ASMIRT assessment applies.
- ✓ **Speak to Ethicare**
We'll confirm your pathway, help secure the role and sponsorship, and review your evidence before you submit.

Visa pathways (incl. 482)

Accreditation answers "can I work as a sonographer here?"; your visa answers "can I live and work in Australia?". They're separate, and how they line up depends on your route.

The ASMIRT certificate supports migration

For **skilled-migration** visas (such as the points-tested 189, 190 and 491), the Department of Home Affairs requires a skills assessment — and for sonographers, the **ASMIRT Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound** is the document that supports it. So the same ASMIRT assessment that unlocks ASAR accreditation also serves your migration application.

Employer-sponsored (Subclass 482)

Many candidates Ethicare supports relocate under an employer-sponsored **482** visa: the employer sponsors the role, and you work toward ASAR accreditation alongside. Australian employers typically expect your ASMIRT recognition and ASAR accreditation to be in place (or well underway) — accreditation is what lets your scanning be billed under Medicare.

Confirm your visa route early

Visa requirements depend on the pathway, so confirm what applies to you with your employer or a registered migration adviser. Whichever route, getting the ASMIRT certificate moving early helps both the accreditation and the migration side.

Applying & what happens next

With your pathway understood and documents assembled, the steps are methodical. Here's the sequence from first checks to working as an accredited sonographer.

1

Prepare your evidence

Identity, ultrasound qualification, transcript, recent-practice evidence, references, CV.

2

Apply to ASMIRT for assessment

Submit your ultrasound qualification and experience for a Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound.

3

Receive your Certificate of Recognition

On Unconditional Recognition — the gateway to both ASAR accreditation and migration.

4

Apply to ASAR (Category 1B)

With the ASMIRT certificate and your citizenship / PR / valid working-visa status.

5

Meet recency requirements

Evidence recent clinical ultrasound practice, or follow ASAR's return-to-practice policy.

6

Accreditation granted

You're on the Register of Accredited Medical Sonographers — eligible to bill under Medicare.

7

Secure your role & start work

Many Australian employers expect accreditation in place (or underway) — with it confirmed, you're ready.

How long it takes & fees

Processing times

Processing times vary with the completeness of your application, verification of your documents and your individual circumstances. The single biggest factor within your control is a complete, well-evidenced submission — and starting the slowest items (document verification, references) early.

Always check the current fees

We've deliberately not printed fee amounts here. ASMIRT charges an assessment fee, and ASAR charges an accreditation application fee plus an annual fee to stay on the register; all are reviewed periodically and ASMIRT/ASAR application fees are non-refundable. Confirm the current figures on the ASMIRT and ASAR websites before you budget or pay — we're happy to point you to them.

A note on sequencing

We recommend you don't make irreversible decisions — such as resigning or relocating — until your ASMIRT recognition and ASAR accreditation pathway is confirmed. Sponsored candidates should coordinate the accreditation and visa timelines with their employer.

Your accreditation journey

From first decision to first day at work — the whole journey on a single page. Keep it nearby; it's the map you'll return to throughout.

Prepare your evidence (qualification, recent practice, references)



Apply to ASMIRT for assessment



Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound issued



Apply to ASAR (Category 1B)



Meet recency requirements



ASAR accreditation granted (Medicare-eligible)



Secure your role → commence practice

Common mistakes to avoid

Almost every avoidable delay we see traces back to one of the issues below. Read this as a pre-flight checklist.

⚠ **Expecting national registration**

Sonographer isn't a protected title — the pathway is ASMIRT recognition then ASAR accreditation, not board registration.

⚠ **Skipping the ASMIRT step**

ASAR Category 1B requires the ASMIRT Certificate of Recognition first — it's the gateway.

⚠ **Thin recent-practice evidence**

Not being able to evidence current clinical ultrasound practice — central to both ASMIRT and ASAR.

⚠ **Forgetting the recency rule**

A certificate over three years old triggers ASAR's recency / return-to-practice requirements.

⚠ **Overlooking ongoing CPD & fees**

ASAR accreditation needs an annual fee and 60 hours CPD every three years to maintain.

⚠ **Irreversible decisions too soon**

Resigning or relocating before your ASMIRT / ASAR pathway is confirmed.

✓ **The fix for all of these**

Start the ASMIRT assessment early, keep your recent-practice evidence organised, then move to ASAR — and confirm your visa route with your employer.

Frequently asked questions

Do I register with a national board as a sonographer?

No. Sonographer isn't a protected title under the National Law, so there's no national-board registration to "practise as a sonographer". The pathway is ASMIRT recognition followed by ASAR accreditation.

What's the difference between ASMIRT and ASAR?

ASMIRT assesses your overseas ultrasound qualification and issues the Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound. **ASAR** is the registry you then join as an Accredited Medical Sonographer (Category 1B). You need the ASMIRT certificate before you can apply to ASAR.

Why does ASAR accreditation matter so much?

Because it's what employers look for, and it's required to bill ultrasound under **Medicare**. In practice it's the credential that lets you work as a sonographer in Australia.

Do I need an ASMIRT assessment for my visa too?

For skilled-migration visas, yes — the ASMIRT Certificate of Recognition supports the Department of Home Affairs skills assessment. So one ASMIRT assessment serves both ASAR accreditation and migration.

Frequently asked questions

What if my qualification is more than three years old?

The recency rule is about your **practice**, not the age of your qualification. If your ASMIRT certificate was obtained more than three years ago, ASAR expects evidence of recent clinical ultrasound practice (around one year part-time / six months full-time in the last three years), or you follow its return-to-clinical-practice policy.

How do I keep my accreditation once I have it?

Pay the annual ASAR fee and complete at least 60 hours of CPD every three years. If you're accredited on a working visa, you'll also show proof of a valid visa at each yearly renewal.

Can I start applying for jobs before I'm accredited?

You can start the conversation early — many recruiters and employers will support you through it. That said, Australian employers generally expect your ASMIRT recognition and ASAR accreditation to be in place or well underway, so it's wise to get the ASMIRT assessment moving first. We help line them up.

Can Ethicare help with all of this?

Yes. We help secure the role and sponsorship, and we guide you through the ASMIRT and ASAR steps — flagging issues while they're still easy to fix. The recognition and accreditation decisions rest with ASMIRT and ASAR.

HOW ETHICARE WILL SUPPORT YOU

You don't have to navigate this alone

If you choose to partner with Ethicare, we'll support you from first enquiry through securing your role and sponsorship, ASMIRT recognition, ASAR accreditation and relocation to your first day at work — with a single point of contact, honest guidance, and help at every stage. We support and guide you through the process; the recognition and accreditation decisions rest with ASMIRT and ASAR.

READY TO BEGIN?

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